17 "I will scatter them before the enemy like the east wind. I will show them My back
and not My face in the day of their calamity." 18 Then some said, "Come, let us make
plans against Jeremiah, for the law will never be lost to the priest, nor counsel to the
wise, nor an oracle to the prophet. Come, let us denounce him and pay no heed to
any of his words." 19 Attend to me, O LORD. Hear what my accusers are saying!
20 Should good be repaid with evil? Yet they have dug a pit for me. Remember how
I stood before You to speak good on their behalf, to turn Your wrath from them.
21 Therefore, hand their children over to famine; pour out the power of the sword
upon them. Let their wives become childless and widowed; let their husbands be
slain by disease, their young men struck down by the sword in battle. 22 Let a cry
be heard from their houses when You suddenly bring raiders against them, for they
have dug a pit to capture me and have hidden snares for my feet. 23 But You, O
LORD, know all their deadly plots against me. Do not wipe out their guilt or blot
out their sin from Your sight. Let them be overthrown before You; deal with them
in the time of Your anger.

19 This is what the LORD says: "Go and buy a clay jar from a potter. Take
some of the elders of the people and leaders of the priests," 2 and go out to the Valley
of Ben-hinnom near the entrance of the Potsherd Gate. Proclaim there the words I
speak to you, 3 saying, 'Hear the word of the LORD, O kings of Judah and residents
of Jerusalem. This is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: I am going
to bring such disaster on this place that the ears of all who hear of it will ring,'
4 because they have abandoned Me and made this a foreign place. They have burned
incense in this place to other gods that neither they nor their fathers nor the kings of
Judah have ever known. They have filled this place with the blood of the innocent.
5 They have built high places to Baal on which to burn their children in the fire as
offerings to Baal—something I never commanded or mentioned, nor did it even
enter My mind. 6 So behold, the days are coming, declares the LORD, when this
place will no longer be called Topheth or the Valley of Ben-hinnom, but the Valley
of Slaughter. 7 And in this place I will ruin the plans of Judah and Jerusalem. I will
make them fall by the sword before their enemies, by the hands of those who seek
their lives, and I will give their carcasses as food to the birds of the air and the beasts
of the earth. 8 I will make this city a desolation and an object of scorn. All who pass
by will be appalled and will scoff at all her wounds. 9 I will make them eat the flesh
of their sons and daughters, and they will eat one another's flesh in the siege and
distress inflicted on them by their enemies who seek their lives.' 10 Then you are
to shatter the jar in the presence of the men who accompany you, 11 and you are
to proclaim to them that this is what the LORD of Hosts says: I will shatter this
nation and this city, like one shatters a potter's jar that can never again be repaired.
They will bury the dead in Topheth until there is no more room to bury them.

12 This is what I will do to this place and to its residents, declares the LORD. I will
make this city like Topheth. 13 "The houses of Jerusalem and the houses of the kings
of Judah will be defiled like that place, Topheth—all the houses on whose rooftops
they burned incense to all the host of heaven and poured out drink offerings to
other gods." 14 Then Jeremiah returned from Topheth, where the LORD had sent
him to prophesy, and he stood in the courtyard of the house of the LORD and
proclaimed to all the people, 15 "This is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel,
says: 'Behold, I am about to bring on this city and on all the villages around it every
disaster I have pronounced against them, because they have stiffened their necks so
as not to heed My words.'"

20 When Pashhur the priest, the son of Immer and the chief official in the house
of the LORD, heard Jeremiah prophesying these things, 2 he had Jeremiah the
prophet beaten and put in the stocks at the Upper Gate of Benjamin, which was by
the house of the LORD. 3 The next day, when Pashhur released Jeremiah from the
stocks, Jeremiah said to him, "The LORD does not call you Pashhur, but Magor-
missabib." 4 For this is what the LORD says: 'I will make you a terror to yourself
and to all your friends. They will fall by the sword of their enemies before your very
eyes. And I will hand Judah over to the king of Babylon, and he will carry them
away to Babylon and put them to the sword.' 5 I will give away all the wealth of this
city—all its products and valuables, and all the treasures of the kings of Judah—to
their enemies. They will plunder them, seize them, and carry them off to Babylon.
6 "And you, Pashhur, and all who live in your house, will go into captivity. You will
go to Babylon, and there you will die and be buried—you and all your friends to
whom you have prophesied these lies.'" 7 You have deceived me, O LORD, and I
was deceived. You have overcome me and prevailed. I am a laughingstock all day
long; everyone mocks me. 8 For whenever I speak, I cry out; I proclaim violence and
destruction. For the word of the LORD has become to me a reproach and derision
all day long.

9 If I say, "I will not mention Him or speak any more in His name," His message
becomes a fire burning in my heart, shut up in my bones, and I become weary of
holding it in, and I cannot prevail. 10 For I have heard the whispering of many:
"Terror is on every side! Report him; let us report him!" All my trusted friends
watch for my fall: "Perhaps he will be deceived so that we may prevail against him
and take our vengeance upon him." 11 But the LORD is with me like a fearsome
warrior. Therefore, my persecutors will stumble and will not prevail. Since they
have not succeeded, they will be utterly put to shame, with an everlasting disgrace
that will never be forgotten. 12 O LORD of Hosts, who examines the righteous, who
sees the heart and mind, let me see Your vengeance upon them, for to You I have
committed my cause. 13 Sing to the LORD! Praise the LORD! For He rescues the
life of the needy from the hands of evildoers. 14 Cursed be the day I was born! May
the day my mother bore me never be blessed. 15 Cursed be the man who brought
my father the news, saying, "A son is born to you," bringing him great joy. 16 May
that man be like the cities that the LORD overthrew without compassion. May
he hear an outcry in the morning and a battle cry at noon, 17 because he did not
kill me in the womb so that my mother might have been my grave, and her womb
forever enlarged. 18 Why did I come out of the womb to see only trouble and sorrow,
and to end my days in shame?

21 This is the word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD when King
Zedekiah sent to him Pashhur son of Malchijah and the priest Zephaniah son
of Maaseiah. They said, 2 "Please inquire of the LORD on our behalf, since
Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon is waging war against us. Perhaps the LORD will
perform for us something like all His past wonders, so that Nebuchadnezzar will
withdraw from us." 3 But Jeremiah answered, "You are to tell Zedekiah that" 4 this
is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'I will turn against you the weapons
of war in your hands, with which you are fighting the king of Babylon and the
Chaldeans who besiege you outside the wall, and I will assemble their forces in
the center of this city.' 5 And I Myself will fight against you with an outstretched
hand and a mighty arm, with anger, fury, and great wrath. 6 I will strike down
the residents of this city, both man and beast. They will die in a terrible plague.'
7 'After that,' declares the LORD, 'I will hand over Zedekiah king of Judah, his
officers, and the people in this city who survive the plague and sword and famine,
to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon and to their enemies who seek their lives. He
will put them to the sword; he will not spare them or show pity or compassion.'
8 Furthermore, you are to tell this people that this is what the LORD says: 'Behold,
I set before you the way of life and the way of death.' 9 Whoever stays in this city
will die by sword and famine and plague, but whoever goes out and surrenders to
the Chaldeans who besiege you will live; he will retain his life like a spoil of war.
10 For I have set My face against this city to bring disaster and not good, declares the
LORD. It will be delivered into the hand of the king of Babylon, who will destroy
it with fire.' 11 Moreover, tell the house of the king of Judah to hear the word of
the LORD. 12 O house of David, this is what the LORD says: 'Administer justice
every morning, and rescue the victim of robbery from the hand of his oppressor,
or My wrath will go forth like fire and burn with no one to extinguish it because
of their evil deeds.' 13 Behold, I am against you who dwell above the valley, atop
the rocky plateau— declares the LORD— you who say, "Who can come against
us? Who can enter our dwellings?" 14 "I will punish you as your deeds deserve,
declares the LORD. I will kindle a fire in your forest that will consume everything
around you.'"

22 This is what the LORD says: "Go down to the palace of the king of Judah
and proclaim this message there," 2 saying, 'Hear the word of the LORD, O king
of Judah, who sits on the throne of David—you and your officials and your people
who enter these gates.' 3 This is what the LORD says: Administer justice and
righteousness. Rescue the victim of robbery from the hand of his oppressor. Do
no wrong or violence to the foreigner, the fatherless, or the widow. Do not shed
innocent blood in this place. 4 For if you will indeed carry out these commands, then
kings who sit on David's throne will enter through the gates of this palace riding
on chariots and horses—they and their officials and their people. 5 "But if you do
not obey these words, then I swear by Myself, declares the LORD, that this house
will become a pile of rubble.'" 6 For this is what the LORD says concerning the
house of the king of Judah: "You are like Gilead to Me, like the summit of Lebanon;
but I will surely turn you into a desert, like cities that are uninhabited." 7 I will
appoint destroyers against you, each man with his weapons, and they will cut down
the choicest of your cedars and throw them into the fire. 8 And many nations will
pass by this city and ask one another, 'Why has the LORD done such a thing to this
great city?' 9 "Then people will reply, 'Because they have forsaken the covenant of
the LORD their God and have worshiped and served other gods.'"

10 Do not weep for the dead king; do not mourn his loss. Weep bitterly for the
one who is exiled, for he will never return to see his native land. 11 For this is what
the LORD says concerning Shallum son of Josiah, king of Judah, who succeeded
his father Josiah but has gone forth from this place: "He will never return," 12 "but
he will die in the place to which he was exiled; he will never see this land again."
13 "Woe to him who builds his palace by unrighteousness, and his upper rooms
without justice, who makes his countrymen serve without pay, and fails to pay
their wages," 14 who says, 'I will build myself a great palace, with spacious upper
rooms.' So he cuts windows in it, panels it with cedar, and paints it with vermilion.
15 Does it make you a king to excel in cedar? Did not your father have food and
drink? He administered justice and righteousness, and so it went well with him.
16 "He took up the cause of the poor and needy, and so it went well with him. Is this
not what it means to know Me?" declares the LORD. 17 "But your eyes and heart
are set on nothing except your own dishonest gain, on shedding innocent blood,
on practicing extortion and oppression." 18 Therefore this is what the LORD says

concerning Jehoiakim son of Josiah king of Judah: "They will not mourn for him: 'Alas, my brother! Alas, my sister!' They will not mourn for him: 'Alas, my master! Alas, his splendor!'" [19] He will be buried like a donkey, dragged away and thrown outside the gates of Jerusalem.

[20] Go up to Lebanon and cry out; raise your voice in Bashan; cry out from Abarim, for all your lovers have been crushed. [21] I warned you when you were secure. You said, 'I will not listen.' This has been your way from youth, that you have not obeyed My voice. [22] The wind will drive away all your shepherds, and your lovers will go into captivity. Then you will be ashamed and humiliated because of all your wickedness. [23] "O inhabitant of Lebanon, nestled in the cedars, how you will groan when pangs of anguish come upon you, agony like a woman in labor." [24] "As surely as I live," declares the LORD, "even if you, Coniah son of Jehoiakim king of Judah, were a signet ring on My right hand, I would pull you off." [25] In fact, I will hand you over to those you dread, who want to take your life—to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon and to the Chaldeans. [26] I will hurl you and the mother who gave you birth into another land, where neither of you were born—and there you both will die. [27] "You will never return to the land for which you long." [28] Is this man Coniah a despised and shattered pot, a jar that no one wants? Why are he and his descendants hurled out and cast into a land they do not know? [29] O land, land, land, hear the word of the LORD! [30] This is what the LORD says: "Enroll this man as childless, a man who will not prosper in his lifetime. None of his descendants will prosper to sit on the throne of David or to rule again in Judah."

23 "Woe to the shepherds who destroy and scatter the sheep of My pasture!" declares the LORD. [2] Therefore this is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says about the shepherds who tend My people: "You have scattered My flock and driven them away, and have not attended to them. Behold, I will attend to you for the evil of your deeds, declares the LORD." [3] Then I Myself will gather the remnant of My flock from all the lands to which I have banished them, and I will return them to their pasture, where they will be fruitful and multiply. [4] I will raise up shepherds over them who will tend them, and they will no longer be afraid or dismayed, nor will any go missing, declares the LORD. [5] Behold, the days are coming, declares the LORD, when I will raise up for David a righteous Branch, and He will reign wisely as King and will administer justice and righteousness in the land. [6] In His days Judah will be saved, and Israel will dwell securely. And this is His name by which He will be called: The LORD Our Righteousness. [7] So behold, the days are coming, declares the LORD, when they will no longer say, 'As surely as the LORD lives, who brought the Israelites up out of the land of Egypt.' [8] "Instead they will say, 'As surely as the LORD lives, who brought and led the descendants of the house of Israel up out of the land of the north and all the other lands to which He had banished them.' Then they will dwell once more in their own land." [9] As for the prophets: My heart is broken within me, and all my bones tremble. I have become like a drunkard, like a man overcome by wine, because of the LORD, because of His holy words. [10] For the land is full of adulterers— because of the curse, the land mourns and the pastures of the wilderness have dried up— their course is evil and their power is misused. [11] "For both prophet and priest are ungodly; even in My house I have found their wickedness," declares the LORD. [12] "Therefore their path will become slick; they will be driven away into the darkness and fall into it. For I will bring disaster upon them in the year of their punishment," declares the LORD.

[13] "Among the prophets of Samaria I saw an offensive thing: They prophesied by Baal and led My people Israel astray." [14] "And among the prophets of Jerusalem I have seen a horrible thing: They commit adultery and walk in lies. They strengthen the hands of evildoers, so that no one turns his back on wickedness. They are all like Sodom to Me; the people of Jerusalem are like Gomorrah." [15] Therefore this is what the LORD of Hosts says concerning the prophets: "I will feed them wormwood and give them poisoned water to drink, for from the prophets of Jerusalem ungodliness has spread throughout the land." [16] This is what the LORD of Hosts says: "Do not listen to the words of the prophets who prophesy to you. They are filling you with false hopes. They speak visions from their own minds, not from the mouth of the LORD." [17] They keep saying to those who despise Me, 'The LORD says that you will have peace,' and to everyone who walks in the stubbornness of his own heart, 'No harm will come to you.' [18] But which of them has stood in the council of the LORD to see and hear His word? Who has given heed to His word and obeyed it?

[19] Behold, the storm of the LORD has gone out with fury, a whirlwind swirling down upon the heads of the wicked. [20] The anger of the LORD will not turn back until He has fully accomplished the purposes of His heart. In the days to come you will understand this clearly. [21] I did not send these prophets, yet they have run with their message; I did not speak to them, yet they have prophesied. [22] "But if they had stood in My council, they would have proclaimed My words to My people and turned them back from their evil ways and deeds." [23] "Am I only a God nearby," declares the LORD, "and not a God far away?" [24] "Can a man hide in secret places where I cannot see him?" declares the LORD. "Do I not fill the heavens and the earth?" declares the LORD. [25] "I have heard the sayings of the prophets who prophesy lies in My name: 'I had a dream! I had a dream!'"

[26] How long will this continue in the hearts of these prophets who prophesy falsehood, these prophets of the delusion of their own minds? [27] They suppose the dreams that they tell one another will make My people forget My name, just as their fathers forgot My name through the worship of Baal. [28] "Let the prophet who has a dream retell it, but let him who has My word speak it truthfully. For what is straw compared to grain?" declares the LORD. [29] "Is not My word like fire," declares the LORD, "and like a hammer that smashes a rock?" [30] "Therefore behold," declares the LORD, "I am against the prophets who steal from one another words they attribute to Me." [31] "Yes," declares the LORD, "I am against the prophets who wag their own tongues and proclaim, 'The LORD declares it.'" [32] "Indeed," declares the LORD, "I am against those who prophesy false dreams and retell them to lead My people astray with their reckless lies. It was not I who sent them or commanded them, and they are of no benefit at all to these people," declares the LORD. [33] "Now when this people or a prophet or priest asks you, 'What is the burden of the LORD?' you are to say to them, 'What burden? I will forsake you, declares the LORD.'" [34] As for the prophet or priest or anyone who claims, 'This is the burden of the LORD,' I will punish that man and his household. [35] This is what each man is to say to his friend and to his brother: 'What has the LORD answered?' or 'What has the LORD spoken?' [36] But refer no more to the burden of the LORD, for each man's word becomes the burden, so that you pervert the words of the living God, the LORD of Hosts, our God. [37] Thus you are to say to the prophet: 'What has the LORD answered you?' and 'What has the LORD spoken?' [38] But if you claim, 'This is the burden of the LORD,' then this is what the LORD says: Because you have said, 'This is the burden of the LORD,' and I specifically told you not to make this claim, [39] therefore I will surely forget you and will cast you out of My presence, both you and the city that I gave to you and your fathers. [40] "And I will bring upon you everlasting shame and perpetual humiliation that will never be forgotten."

24 After Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon had carried away Jeconiah son of Jehoiakim king of Judah, as well as the officials of Judah and the craftsmen and metalsmiths from Jerusalem, and had brought them to Babylon, the LORD showed me two baskets of figs placed in front of the temple of the LORD. [2] One basket had very good figs, like those that ripen early, but the other basket contained very poor figs, so bad they could not be eaten. [3] "Jeremiah," the LORD asked, "what do you see?" "Figs!" I replied. "The good figs are very good, but the bad figs are very bad, so bad they cannot be eaten." [4] Then the word of the LORD came to me, saying, [5] "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'Like these good figs, so I regard as good the exiles from Judah, whom I have sent away from this place to the land of the Chaldeans.'" [6] I will keep My eyes on them for good and will return them to this land. I will build them up and not tear them down; I will plant them and not uproot them. [7] I will give them a heart to know Me, that I am the LORD. They will be My people, and I will be their God, for they will return to Me with all their heart. [8] But like the bad figs, so bad they cannot be eaten,' says the LORD, 'so will I deal with Zedekiah king of Judah, his officials, and the remnant of Jerusalem —those remaining in this land and those living in the land of Egypt.' [9] I will make them a horror and an offense to all the kingdoms of the earth, a disgrace and an object of scorn, ridicule, and cursing wherever I have banished them. [10] "And I will send against them sword and famine and plague, until they have perished from the land that I gave to them and their fathers.'"

25 This is the word that came to Jeremiah concerning all the people of Judah in the fourth year of Jehoiakim son of Josiah king of Judah, which was the first year of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon. [2] So the prophet Jeremiah spoke to all the people of Judah and all the residents of Jerusalem as follows: [3] "From the thirteenth year of Josiah son of Amon king of Judah until this very day—twenty-three years—the word of the LORD has come to me, and I have spoken to you again and again, but you have not listened." [4] And the LORD has sent all His servants the prophets to you again and again, but you have not listened or inclined your ear to hear. [5] The prophets told you, 'Turn now, each of you, from your evil ways and deeds, and you can dwell in the land that the LORD has given to you and your fathers forever and ever.' [6] Do not follow other gods to serve and worship them, and do not provoke Me to anger with the works of your hands. Then I will do you no harm.' [7] 'But to your own harm, you have not listened to Me,' declares the LORD, 'so you have provoked Me to anger with the works of your hands.' [8] Therefore this is what the LORD of Hosts says: 'Because you have not obeyed My words,' [9] behold, I will summon all the families of the north, declares the LORD, and I will send for My servant Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, whom I will bring against this land, against its residents, and against all the surrounding nations. So I will devote them to destruction and make them an object of horror and contempt, an everlasting desolation. [10] Moreover, I will banish from them the sounds of joy and gladness, the voices of the bride and bridegroom, the sound of the millstones, and the light of the lamp. [11] And this whole land will become a desolate wasteland, and these nations will serve the king of Babylon for seventy years.

[12] But when seventy years are complete, I will punish the king of Babylon and that nation, the land of the Chaldeans, for their guilt, declares the LORD, and I will make it an everlasting desolation. [13] I will bring upon that land all the words

I have pronounced against it, all that is written in this book, which Jeremiah has prophesied against all the nations. [14] "For many nations and great kings will enslave them, and I will repay them according to their deeds and according to the work of their hands.'" [15] This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, said to me: "Take from My hand this cup of the wine of wrath, and make all the nations to whom I send you drink from it." [16] "And they will drink and stagger and go out of their minds, because of the sword that I will send among them."

[17] So I took the cup from the LORD's hand and made all the nations drink from it, each one to whom the LORD had sent me, [18] to make them a ruin, an object of horror and contempt and cursing, as they are to this day—Jerusalem and the cities of Judah, its kings and officials; [19] Pharaoh king of Egypt, his officials, his leaders, and all his people; [20] all the mixed tribes; all the kings of Uz; all the kings of the Philistines: Ashkelon, Gaza, Ekron, and the remnant of Ashdod; [21] Edom, Moab, and the Ammonites; [22] all the kings of Tyre and Sidon; the kings of the coastlands across the sea; [23] Dedan, Tema, Buz, and all who cut the corners of their hair; [24] all the kings of Arabia, and all the kings of the mixed tribes who dwell in the desert; [25] all the kings of Zimri, Elam, and Media; [26] all the kings of the north, both near and far, one after another—all the kingdoms on the face of the earth. And after all of them, the king of Sheshach will drink it too. [27] "Then you are to tell them that this is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'Drink, get drunk, and vomit. Fall down and never get up again, because of the sword I will send among you.'" [28] If they refuse to take the cup from your hand and drink it, you are to tell them that this is what the LORD of Hosts says: 'You most certainly must drink it!' [29] For behold, I am beginning to bring disaster on the city that bears My Name, so how could you possibly go unpunished? You will not go unpunished, for I am calling down a sword upon all the inhabitants of the earth, declares the LORD of Hosts.' [30] So you are to prophesy all these words against them and say to them: 'The LORD will roar from on high; He will raise His voice from His holy habitation. He will roar loudly over His pasture; like those who tread the grapes, He will call out with a shout against all the inhabitants of the earth.' [31] "The tumult will resound to the ends of the earth because the LORD brings a charge against the nations. He brings judgment on all mankind and puts the wicked to the sword,'" declares the LORD. [32] This is what the LORD of Hosts says: "Behold! Disaster is spreading from nation to nation; a mighty storm is rising from the ends of the earth." [33] Those slain by the LORD on that day will be spread from one end of the earth to the other. They will not be mourned, gathered, or buried. They will be like dung lying on the ground. [34] Wail, you shepherds, and cry out; roll in the dust, you leaders of the flock. For the days of your slaughter have come; you will fall and be shattered like fine pottery. [35] Flight will evade the shepherds, and escape will elude the leaders of the flock. [36] Hear the cry of the shepherds, the wailing of the leaders of the flock, for the LORD is destroying their pasture. [37] The peaceful meadows have been silenced because of the LORD's burning anger. [38] He has left His den like a lion, for their land has been made a desolation by the sword of the oppressor, and because of the fierce anger of the LORD.

26 At the beginning of the reign of Jehoiakim son of Josiah king of Judah, this word came from the LORD: [2] "This is what the LORD says: Stand in the courtyard of the house of the LORD and speak all the words I have commanded you to speak to all the cities of Judah who come to worship there. Do not omit a word." [3] Perhaps they will listen and turn—each from his evil way of life—so that I may relent of the disaster I am planning to bring upon them because of the evil of their deeds. [4] And you are to tell them that this is what the LORD says: 'If you do not listen to Me and walk in My law, which I have set before you,' [5] and if you do not listen to the words of My servants the prophets, whom I have sent you again and again even though you did not listen, [6] "then I will make this house like Shiloh, and I will make this city an object of cursing among all the nations of the earth.'" [7] Now the priests and prophets and all the people heard Jeremiah speaking these words in the house of the LORD, [8] and as soon as he had finished telling all the people everything the LORD had commanded him to say, the priests and prophets and all the people seized him, shouting, "You must surely die!" [9] "How dare you prophesy in the name of the LORD that this house will become like Shiloh and this city will be desolate and deserted!" And all the people assembled against Jeremiah in the house of the LORD. [10] When the officials of Judah heard these things, they went up from the king's palace to the house of the LORD and sat there at the entrance of the New Gate.

[11] Then the priests and prophets said to the officials and all the people, "This man is worthy of death, for he has prophesied against this city, as you have heard with your own ears!" [12] But Jeremiah said to all the officials and all the people, "The LORD sent me to prophesy against this house and against this city all the words that you have heard." [13] So now, correct your ways and deeds, and obey the voice of the LORD your God, so that He might relent of the disaster He has pronounced against you. [14] As for me, here I am in your hands; do to me what you think is good and right. [15] "But know for certain that if you put me to death, you will bring innocent blood upon yourselves, upon this city, and upon its residents; for truly the LORD has sent me to speak all these words in your hearing."

[16] Then the officials and all the people told the priests and prophets, "This man is not worthy of death, for he has spoken to us in the name of the LORD our God!" [17] Some of the elders of the land stood up and said to the whole assembly of the people, [18] "Micah the Moreshite prophesied in the days of Hezekiah king of Judah and told all the people of Judah that this is what the LORD of Hosts says: 'Zion will be plowed like a field, Jerusalem will become a heap of rubble, and the temple mount a wooded ridge.'" [19] "Did Hezekiah king of Judah or anyone else in Judah put him to death? Did Hezekiah not fear the LORD and seek His favor, and did not the LORD relent of the disaster He had pronounced against them? But we are about to bring great harm on ourselves!" [20] Now there was another man prophesying in the name of the LORD, Uriah son of Shemaiah from Kiriath-jearim. He prophesied against this city and against this land the same things that Jeremiah did. [21] King Jehoiakim and all his mighty men and officials heard his words, and the king sought to put him to death. But when Uriah found out about it, he fled in fear and went to Egypt. [22] Then King Jehoiakim sent men to Egypt: Elnathan son of Achbor along with some other men. [23] They brought Uriah out of Egypt and took him to King Jehoiakim, who had him put to the sword and his body thrown into the burial place of the common people. [24] Nevertheless, Ahikam son of Shaphan supported Jeremiah, so he was not handed over to the people to be put to death.

27 At the beginning of the reign of Zedekiah son of Josiah king of Judah, this word came to Jeremiah from the LORD. [2] This is what the LORD said to me: "Make for yourself a yoke out of leather straps and put it on your neck." [3] Send word to the kings of Edom, Moab, Ammon, Tyre, and Sidon through the envoys who have come to Jerusalem to Zedekiah king of Judah. [4] Give them a message from the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, to relay to their masters: [5] By My great power and outstretched arm, I made the earth and the men and beasts on the face of it, and I give it to whom I please. [6] So now I have placed all these lands under the authority of My servant Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon. I have even made the beasts of the field subject to him.

[7] All nations will serve him and his son and grandson, until the time of his own land comes; then many nations and great kings will enslave him. [8] As for the nation or kingdom that does not serve Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon and does not place its neck under his yoke, I will punish that nation by sword and famine and plague, declares the LORD, until I have destroyed it by his hand. [9] But as for you, do not listen to your prophets, your diviners, your interpreters of dreams, your mediums, or your sorcerers who declare, 'You will not serve the king of Babylon.'

[10] For they prophesy to you a lie that will serve to remove you from your land; I will banish you and you will perish. [11] "But the nation that will put its neck under the yoke of the king of Babylon and serve him, I will leave in its own land, to cultivate it and reside in it, declares the LORD." [12] And to Zedekiah king of Judah I spoke the same message: "Put your necks under the yoke of the king of Babylon; serve him and his people, and live!" [13] Why should you and your people die by sword and famine and plague, as the LORD has decreed against any nation that does not serve the king of Babylon?

[14] Do not listen to the words of the prophets who say, 'You must not serve the king of Babylon,' for they are prophesying to you a lie. [15] "For I have not sent them, declares the LORD, and yet they are prophesying falsely in My name; therefore I will banish you, and you will perish—you and the prophets who prophesy to you." [16] Then I said to the priests and to all this people, "This is what the LORD says: Do not listen to the words of your prophets who prophesy to you, saying, 'Look, very soon now the articles from the house of the LORD will be brought back from Babylon.' They are prophesying to you a lie." [17] Do not listen to them. Serve the king of Babylon and live! Why should this city become a ruin? [18] If they are indeed prophets and the word of the LORD is with them, let them now plead with the LORD of Hosts that the articles remaining in the house of the LORD, in the palace of the king of Judah, and in Jerusalem, not be taken to Babylon. [19] For this is what the LORD of Hosts says about the pillars, the sea, the bases, and the rest of the articles that remain in this city, [20] which Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon did not take when he carried Jeconiah son of Jehoiakim king of Judah into exile from Jerusalem to Babylon, along with all the nobles of Judah and Jerusalem. [21] Yes, this is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says about the articles that remain in the house of the LORD, in the palace of the king of Judah, and in Jerusalem: [22] "'They will be carried to Babylon and will remain there until the day I attend to them again,' declares the LORD. 'Then I will bring them back and restore them to this place.'"

28 In the fifth month of that same year, the fourth year, near the beginning of the reign of King Zedekiah of Judah, the prophet Hananiah son of Azzur, who was from Gibeon, said to me in the house of the LORD in the presence of the priests and all the people: [2] "This is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'I have broken the yoke of the king of Babylon.'" [3] Within two years I will restore to this place all the articles of the house of the LORD that Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon removed from here and carried to Babylon. [4] "And I will restore to this place Jeconiah son of Jehoiakim king of Judah, along with all the exiles from Judah who went to Babylon,' declares the LORD, 'for I will break the yoke of the

king of Babylon.'" [5] Then the prophet Jeremiah replied to the prophet Hananiah in the presence of the priests and all the people who were standing in the house of the LORD. [6] "Amen!" Jeremiah said. "May the LORD do so! May the LORD fulfill the words you have prophesied, and may He restore the articles of His house and all the exiles back to this place from Babylon." [7] Nevertheless, listen now to this message I am speaking in your hearing and in the hearing of all the people. [8] The prophets of old who preceded you and me prophesied war, disaster, and plague against many lands and great kingdoms. [9] "As for the prophet who prophesies peace, only if the word of the prophet comes true will the prophet be recognized as one the LORD has truly sent."

[10] Then the prophet Hananiah took the yoke off the neck of Jeremiah the prophet and broke it. [11] And in the presence of all the people Hananiah proclaimed, "This is what the LORD says: 'In this way, within two years I will break the yoke of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon off the neck of all the nations.'" At this, Jeremiah the prophet went on his way. [12] But shortly after Hananiah the prophet had broken the yoke off his neck, the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah: [13] "Go and tell Hananiah that this is what the LORD says: 'You have broken a yoke of wood, but in its place you have fashioned a yoke of iron.'" [14] "For this is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'I have put a yoke of iron on the neck of all these nations to make them serve Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and they will serve him. I have even given him control of the beasts of the field.'" [15] Then the prophet Jeremiah said to the prophet Hananiah, "Listen, Hananiah! The LORD did not send you, but you have persuaded this people to trust in a lie." [16] "Therefore this is what the LORD says: 'I am about to remove you from the face of the earth. You will die this year because you have preached rebellion against the LORD.'" [17] And in the seventh month of that very year, the prophet Hananiah died.

29 This is the text of the letter that Jeremiah the prophet sent from Jerusalem to the surviving elders among the exiles and to the priests, the prophets, and all the others Nebuchadnezzar had carried into exile from Jerusalem to Babylon. [2] (This was after King Jeconiah, the queen mother, the court officials, the officials of Judah and Jerusalem, the craftsmen, and the metalsmiths had been exiled from Jerusalem.) [3] The letter was entrusted to Elasah son of Shaphan and Gemariah son of Hilkiah, whom Zedekiah king of Judah sent to King Nebuchadnezzar in Babylon. It stated: [4] This is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says to all the exiles who were carried away from Jerusalem to Babylon: [5] "Build houses and settle down. Plant gardens and eat their produce." [6] Take wives and have sons and daughters. Take wives for your sons and give your daughters in marriage, so that they too may have sons and daughters. Multiply there; do not decrease. [7] "Seek the prosperity of the city to which I have sent you as exiles. Pray to the LORD on its behalf, for if it prospers, you too will prosper." [8] For this is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: "Do not be deceived by the prophets and diviners among you, and do not listen to the dreams you elicit from them." [9] "For they are falsely prophesying to you in My name; I have not sent them, declares the LORD."

[10] For this is what the LORD says: "When Babylon's seventy years are complete, I will attend to you and confirm My promise to restore you to this place."

[11] For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope. [12] Then you will call upon Me and come and pray to Me, and I will listen to you. [13] You will seek Me and find Me when you search for Me with all your heart. [14] "I will be found by you, declares the LORD, and I will restore you from captivity and gather you from all the nations and places to which I have banished you, declares the LORD. I will restore you to the place from which I sent you into exile."

[15] Because you may say, "The LORD has raised up for us prophets in Babylon," [16] this is what the LORD says about the king who sits on David's throne and all the people who remain in this city, your brothers who did not go with you into exile— [17] this is what the LORD of Hosts says: "I will send against them sword and famine and plague, and I will make them like rotten figs, so bad they cannot be eaten." [18] I will pursue them with sword and famine and plague. I will make them a horror to all the kingdoms of the earth—a curse, a desolation, and an object of scorn and reproach among all the nations to which I banish them. [19] "I will do this because they have not listened to My words, declares the LORD, which I sent to them again and again through My servants the prophets. And neither have you exiles listened, declares the LORD." [20] So hear the word of the LORD, all you exiles I have sent away from Jerusalem to Babylon.

[21] This is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says about Ahab son of Kolaiah and Zedekiah son of Maaseiah, who are prophesying to you lies in My name: "I will deliver them to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and he will kill them before your very eyes." [22] Because of them, all the exiles of Judah who are in Babylon will use this curse: 'May the LORD make you like Zedekiah and Ahab, whom the king of Babylon roasted in the fire!' [23] "For they have committed an outrage in Israel by committing adultery with the wives of their neighbors and speaking lies in My name, which I did not command them to do. I am He who knows, and I am a witness, declares the LORD." [24] You are to tell Shemaiah the Nehelamite that [25] this is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: "In your own name you have sent out letters to all the people of Jerusalem, to the priest Zephaniah son of Maaseiah, and to all the priests. You said to Zephaniah:" [26] 'The LORD has appointed you priest in place of Jehoiada, to be the chief officer in the house of the LORD, responsible for any madman who acts like a prophet—you must put him in stocks and neck irons.' [27] So now, why have you not rebuked Jeremiah of Anathoth, who poses as a prophet among you? [28] "For he has sent to us in Babylon, claiming: Since the exile will be lengthy, build houses and settle down; plant gardens and eat their produce.'" [29] (Zephaniah the priest, however, had read this letter to Jeremiah the prophet.) [30] Then the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah: [31] "Send a message telling all the exiles what the LORD says concerning Shemaiah the Nehelamite. Because Shemaiah has prophesied to you—though I did not send him—and has made you trust in a lie," [32] "this is what the LORD says: 'I will surely punish Shemaiah the Nehelamite and his descendants. He will have no one left among this people, nor will he see the good that I will bring to My people, declares the LORD, for he has preached rebellion against the LORD.'"

30 This is the word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD: [2] "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'Write in a book all the words that I have spoken to you.'" [3] "For behold, the days are coming, declares the LORD, when I will restore from captivity My people Israel and Judah, declares the LORD. I will restore them to the land that I gave to their fathers, and they will possess it.'" [4] These are the words that the LORD spoke concerning Israel and Judah. [5] Yes, this is what the LORD says: "A cry of panic is heard— a cry of terror, not of peace." [6] Ask now, and see: Can a male give birth? Why then do I see every man with his hands on his stomach like a woman in labor and every face turned pale? [7] How awful that day will be! None will be like it! It is the time of Jacob's distress, but he will be saved out of it.

[8] On that day, declares the LORD of Hosts, I will break the yoke off their necks and tear off their bonds, and no longer will strangers enslave them. [9] Instead, they will serve the LORD their God and David their king, whom I will raise up for them. [10] As for you, O Jacob My servant, do not be afraid, declares the LORD, and do not be dismayed, O Israel. For I will surely save you out of a distant place, your descendants from the land of their captivity! Jacob will return to quiet and ease, with no one to make him afraid. [11] "For I am with you to save you, declares the LORD. Though I will completely destroy all the nations to which I have scattered you, I will not completely destroy you. Yet I will discipline you justly, and will by no means leave you unpunished." [12] For this is what the LORD says: "Your injury is incurable; your wound is grievous." [13] There is no one to plead your cause, no remedy for your sores, no recovery for you. [14] All your lovers have forgotten you; they no longer seek you, for I have struck you as an enemy would, with the discipline of someone cruel, because of your great iniquity and your numerous sins. [15] Why do you cry out over your wound? Your pain has no cure! Because of your great iniquity and your numerous sins I have done these things to you.

[16] Nevertheless, all who devour you will be devoured, and all your adversaries—every one of them— will go off into exile. Those who plundered you will be plundered, and all who raided you will be raided. [17] "But I will restore your health and heal your wounds, declares the LORD, because they call you an outcast, Zion, for whom no one cares."

[18] This is what the LORD says: "I will restore the fortunes of Jacob's tents and have compassion on his dwellings. And the city will be rebuilt on her own ruins, and the palace will stand in its rightful place." [19] Thanksgiving will proceed from them, a sound of celebration. I will multiply them, and they will not be decreased; I will honor them, and they will not be belittled. [20] Their children will be as in days of old, and their congregation will be established before Me; and I will punish all their oppressors. [21] "Their leader will be one of their own, and their ruler will arise from their midst. And I will bring him near, and he will approach Me, for who would dare on his own to approach Me?" declares the LORD. [22] "And you will be My people, and I will be your God." [23] Behold, the storm of the LORD has gone out with fury, a whirlwind swirling down upon the heads of the wicked. [24] The fierce anger of the LORD will not turn back until He has fully accomplished the purposes of His heart. In the days to come you will understand this.

31 "At that time," declares the LORD, "I will be the God of all the families of Israel, and they will be My people." [2] This is what the LORD says: "The people who survived the sword found favor in the wilderness when Israel went to find rest." [3] The LORD appeared to us in the past, saying: "I have loved you with an everlasting love; therefore I have drawn you with loving devotion." [4] Again I will build you, and you will be rebuilt, O Virgin Israel. Again you will take up your tambourines and go out in joyful dancing. [5] Again you will plant vineyards on the hills of Samaria; the farmers will plant and enjoy the fruit. [6] "For there will be a day when watchmen will call out on the hills of Ephraim, 'Arise, let us go up to Zion, to the LORD our God!'" [7] For this is what the LORD says: "Sing with joy for Jacob; shout for the foremost of the nations! Make your praises heard, and say, 'O LORD, save Your people, the remnant of Israel!'" [8] Behold, I will bring them from the land of the north and gather them from the farthest parts of the earth, including the blind and the lame, expectant mothers and women in labor. They will return as a great assembly! [9] "They will come with weeping, and by their supplication I will lead

them; I will make them walk beside streams of waters, on a level path where they will not stumble. For I am Israel's Father, and Ephraim is My firstborn." [10] Hear, O nations, the word of the LORD, and proclaim it in distant coastlands: "The One who scattered Israel will gather them and keep them as a shepherd keeps his flock." [11] For the LORD has ransomed Jacob and redeemed him from the hand that had overpowered him. [12] They will come and shout for joy on the heights of Zion; they will be radiant over the bounty of the LORD— the grain, new wine, and oil, and the young of the flocks and herds. Their life will be like a well-watered garden, and never again will they languish.

[13] Then the maidens will rejoice with dancing, young men and old as well. I will turn their mourning into joy, and give them comfort and joy for their sorrow. [14] "I will fill the souls of the priests abundantly, and will fill My people with My goodness," declares the LORD. [15] This is what the LORD says: "A voice is heard in Ramah, mourning and great weeping, Rachel weeping for her children, and refusing to be comforted, because they are no more." [16] This is what the LORD says: "Keep your voice from weeping and your eyes from tears, for the reward for your work will come, declares the LORD. Then your children will return from the land of the enemy." [17] So there is hope for your future, declares the LORD, and your children will return to their own land. [18] I have surely heard Ephraim's moaning: 'You disciplined me severely, like an untrained calf. Restore me, that I may return, for You are the LORD my God.' [19] After I returned, I repented; and after I was instructed, I struck my thigh in grief. I was ashamed and humiliated because I bore the disgrace of my youth.' [20] "Is not Ephraim a precious son to Me, a delightful child? Though I often speak against him, I still remember him. Therefore My heart yearns for him; I have great compassion for him," declares the LORD. [21] "Set up the roadmarks, establish the signposts. Keep the highway in mind, the road you have traveled. Return, O Virgin Israel, return to these cities of yours." [22] "How long will you wander, O faithless daughter? For the LORD has created a new thing in the land— a woman will shelter a man." [23] This is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: "When I restore them from captivity, they will once again speak this word in the land of Judah and in its cities: 'May the LORD bless you, O righteous dwelling place, O holy mountain.'" [24] And Judah and all its cities will dwell together in the land, the farmers and those who move with the flocks, [25] "for I will refresh the weary soul and replenish all who are weak."

[26] At this I awoke and looked around. My sleep had been most pleasant to me. [27] "The days are coming," declares the LORD, "when I will sow the house of Israel and the house of Judah with the seed of man and of beast." [28] "Just as I watched over them to uproot and tear down, to demolish, destroy, and bring disaster, so I will watch over them to build and to plant," declares the LORD. [29] "In those days, it will no longer be said: 'The fathers have eaten sour grapes, and the teeth of the children are set on edge.'" [30] Instead, each will die for his own iniquity. If anyone eats the sour grapes, his own teeth will be set on edge.

[31] Behold, the days are coming, declares the LORD, when I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel and with the house of Judah. [32] "It will not be like the covenant I made with their fathers when I took them by the hand to lead them out of the land of Egypt— a covenant they broke, though I was a husband to them," declares the LORD. [33] "But this is the covenant I will make with the house of Israel after those days, declares the LORD. I will put My law in their minds and inscribe it on their hearts. And I will be their God, and they will be My people." [34] "No longer will each man teach his neighbor or his brother, saying, 'Know the LORD,' because they will all know Me, from the least of them to the greatest, declares the LORD. For I will forgive their iniquities and will remember their sins no more."

[35] Thus says the LORD, who gives the sun for light by day, who sets in order the moon and stars for light by night, who stirs up the sea so that its waves roar —the LORD of Hosts is His name: [36] "Only if this fixed order departed from My presence, declares the LORD, would Israel's descendants ever cease to be a nation before Me." [37] This is what the LORD says: "Only if the heavens above could be measured and the foundations of the earth below searched out would I reject all of Israel's descendants because of all they have done," declares the LORD. [38] "The days are coming," declares the LORD, "when this city will be rebuilt for Me, from the tower of Hananel to the Corner Gate." [39] The measuring line will once again stretch out straight to the hill of Gareb and then turn toward Goah. [40] "The whole valley of the dead bodies and ashes, and all the fields as far as the Kidron Valley, to the corner of the Horse Gate to the east, will be holy to the LORD. It will never again be uprooted or demolished."

32 This is the word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD in the tenth year of Zedekiah king of Judah, which was the eighteenth year of Nebuchadnezzar. [2] At that time the army of the king of Babylon was besieging Jerusalem, and Jeremiah the prophet was imprisoned in the courtyard of the guard, which was in the palace of the king of Judah. [3] For Zedekiah king of Judah had imprisoned him, saying: "Why are you prophesying like this? You claim that the LORD says, 'Behold, I am about to deliver this city into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he will capture it.'" [4] Zedekiah king of Judah will not escape from the hands of the Chaldeans, but he will surely be delivered into the hand of the king of Babylon, and will speak with him face to face and see him eye to eye. [5] "He will take Zedekiah to Babylon, where he will stay until I attend to him, declares the LORD. If you fight against the Chaldeans, you will not succeed.'" [6] Jeremiah replied, "The word of the LORD came to me, saying:" [7] Behold! Hanamel, the son of your uncle Shallum, is coming to you to say, 'Buy for yourself my field in Anathoth, for you have the right of redemption to buy it.' [8] "Then, as the LORD had said, my cousin Hanamel came to me in the courtyard of the guard and urged me, 'Please buy my field in Anathoth in the land of Benjamin, for you own the right of inheritance and redemption. Buy it for yourself.'" Then I knew that this was the word of the LORD. [9] So I bought the field in Anathoth from my cousin Hanamel, and I weighed out seventeen shekels of silver. [10] I signed and sealed the deed, called in witnesses, and weighed out the silver on the scales. [11] Then I took the deed of purchase—the sealed copy with its terms and conditions, as well as the open copy— [12] and I gave this deed to Baruch son of Neriah, the son of Mahseiah, in the sight of my cousin Hanamel and the witnesses who were signing the purchase agreement and all the Jews sitting in the courtyard of the guard. [13] In their sight I instructed Baruch, [14] "This is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: Take these deeds—both the sealed copy and the open copy of the deed of purchase—and put them in a clay jar to preserve them for a long time." [15] "For this is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: Houses, fields, and vineyards will again be bought in this land." [16] After I had given the deed of purchase to Baruch son of Neriah, I prayed to the LORD: [17] "Oh, Lord GOD! You have made the heavens and the earth by Your great power and outstretched arm. Nothing is too difficult for You!" [18] You show loving devotion to thousands but lay the iniquity of the fathers into the laps of their children after them, O great and mighty God whose name is the LORD of Hosts, [19] the One great in counsel and mighty in deed, whose eyes are on all the ways of the sons of men, to reward each one according to his ways and according to the fruit of his deeds. [20] You performed signs and wonders in the land of Egypt, and You do so to this very day, both in Israel and among all mankind. And You have made a name for Yourself, as is the case to this day. [21] You brought Your people Israel out of the land of Egypt with signs and wonders, with a strong hand and an outstretched arm, and with great terror. [22] You gave them this land that You had sworn to give their fathers, a land flowing with milk and honey. [23] They came in and possessed it, but they did not obey Your voice or walk in Your law. They failed to perform all that You commanded them to do, and so You have brought upon them all this disaster.

[24] See how the siege ramps are mounted against the city to capture it. And by sword and famine and plague, the city has been given into the hands of the Chaldeans who are fighting against it. What You have spoken has happened, as You now see! [25] "Yet You, O Lord GOD, have said to me, 'Buy for yourself the field with silver and call in witnesses, even though the city has been delivered into the hands of the Chaldeans!'" [26] Then the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah: [27] "Behold, I am the LORD, the God of all flesh. Is anything too difficult for Me?" [28] Therefore this is what the LORD says: Behold, I am about to deliver this city into the hands of the Chaldeans and of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, who will capture it.

[29] And the Chaldeans who are fighting against this city will come in, set it on fire, and burn it, along with the houses of those who provoked Me to anger by burning incense to Baal on their rooftops and by pouring out drink offerings to other gods. [30] For the children of Israel and of Judah have done nothing but evil in My sight from their youth; indeed, they have done nothing but provoke Me to anger by the work of their hands, declares the LORD. [31] For this city has aroused My wrath and fury from the day it was built until now. Therefore I will remove it from My presence [32] because of all the evil the children of Israel and of Judah have done to provoke Me to anger—they, their kings, their officials, their priests and prophets, the men of Judah, and the residents of Jerusalem. [33] They have turned their backs to Me and not their faces. Though I taught them again and again, they would not listen or respond to discipline. [34] They have placed their abominations in the house that bears My Name, and so have defiled it. [35] They have built the high places of Baal in the Valley of Hinnom to make their sons and daughters pass through the fire to Molech—something I never commanded them, nor had it ever entered My mind, that they should commit such an abomination and cause Judah to sin. [36] Now therefore, about this city of which you say, 'It will be delivered into the hand of the king of Babylon by sword and famine and plague,' this is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: [37] I will surely gather My people from all the lands to which I have banished them in My furious anger and great wrath, and I will return them to this place and make them dwell in safety. [38] They will be My people, and I will be their God. [39] I will give them one heart and one way, so that they will always fear Me for their own good and for the good of their children after them. [40] I will make an everlasting covenant with them: I will never turn away from doing good to them, and I will put My fear in their hearts, so that they will never turn away from Me. [41] Yes, I will rejoice in doing them good, and I will faithfully plant them in this land with all My heart and with all My soul. [42] For this is what the LORD says: Just as I have brought all this great disaster on this people, so I will bring on them all the good I have promised them. [43] And fields will be bought in this land about which you are saying, 'It is a desolation, without man or beast; it has been delivered into the hands of the Chaldeans.' [44] "Fields will be purchased with silver, and deeds will be signed, sealed, and witnessed in the land of Benjamin, in the areas surrounding

Jerusalem, and in the cities of Judah—the cities of the hill country, the foothills, and the Negev—because I will restore them from captivity, declares the LORD."

33 While Jeremiah was still confined in the courtyard of the guard, the word of the LORD came to him a second time: [2] "Thus says the LORD who made the earth, the LORD who formed it and established it, the LORD is His name:" [3] Call to Me, and I will answer and show you great and unsearchable things you do not know. [4] For this is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says about the houses of this city and the palaces of the kings of Judah that have been torn down for defense against the siege ramps and the sword: [5] The Chaldeans are coming to fight and to fill those places with the corpses of the men I will strike down in My anger and in My wrath. I have hidden My face from this city because of all its wickedness. [6] Nevertheless, I will bring to it health and healing, and I will heal its people and reveal to them the abundance of peace and truth. [7] I will restore Judah and Israel from captivity and will rebuild them as in former times.

[8] And I will cleanse them from all the iniquity they have committed against Me, and will forgive all their sins of rebellion against Me. [9] So this city will bring Me renown, joy, praise, and glory before all the nations of the earth, who will hear of all the good I do for it. They will tremble in awe because of all the goodness and prosperity that I will provide for it. [10] This is what the LORD says: In this place you say is a wasteland without man or beast, in the cities of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem that are deserted—inhabited by neither man nor beast—there will be heard again [11] the sounds of joy and gladness, the voices of the bride and bridegroom, and the voices of those bringing thank offerings into the house of the LORD, saying: 'Give thanks to the LORD of Hosts, for the LORD is good; His loving devotion endures forever.' For I will restore the land from captivity as in former times, says the LORD.

[12] This is what the LORD of Hosts says: In this desolate place, without man or beast, and in all its cities, there will once more be pastures for shepherds to rest their flocks. [13] In the cities of the hill country, the foothills, and the Negev, in the land of Benjamin and the cities surrounding Jerusalem, and in the cities of Judah, the flocks will again pass under the hands of the one who counts them, says the LORD. [14] Behold, the days are coming, declares the LORD, when I will fulfill the gracious promise that I have spoken to the house of Israel and the house of Judah. [15] In those days and at that time I will cause to sprout for David a righteous Branch, and He will administer justice and righteousness in the land. [16] In those days Judah will be saved, and Jerusalem will dwell securely, and this is the name by which it will be called: The LORD Our Righteousness.

[17] For this is what the LORD says: David will never lack a man to sit on the throne of the house of Israel, [18] "nor will the priests who are Levites ever fail to have a man before Me to offer burnt offerings, to burn grain offerings, and to present sacrifices." [19] And the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah: [20] "This is what the LORD says: If you can break My covenant with the day and My covenant with the night, so that day and night cease to occupy their appointed time," [21] then My covenant may also be broken with David My servant and with My ministers the Levites who are priests, so that David will not have a son to reign on his throne. [22] "As the hosts of heaven cannot be counted and as the sand on the seashore cannot be measured, so too will I multiply the descendants of My servant David and the Levites who minister before Me." [23] Moreover, the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah: [24] "Have you not noticed what these people are saying: 'The LORD has rejected the two families He had chosen'? So they despise My people and no longer regard them as a nation." [25] This is what the LORD says: If I have not established My covenant with the day and the night and the fixed order of heaven and earth, [26] "then I would also reject the descendants of Jacob and of My servant David, so as not to take from his descendants rulers over the descendants of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. For I will restore them from captivity and will have compassion on them."

34 This is the word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD when Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, all his army, all the earthly kingdoms under his control, and all the other nations were fighting against Jerusalem and all its surrounding cities. [2] The LORD, the God of Israel, told Jeremiah to go and speak to Zedekiah king of Judah and tell him that this is what the LORD says: "Behold, I am about to deliver this city into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he will burn it down." [3] And you yourself will not escape his grasp, but will surely be captured and delivered into his hand. You will see the king of Babylon eye to eye and speak with him face to face; and you will go to Babylon. [4] Yet hear the word of the LORD, O Zedekiah king of Judah. This is what the LORD says concerning you: You will not die by the sword; [5] "you will die in peace. As spices were burned for your fathers, the former kings who preceded you, so people will burn spices for you and lament, 'Alas, O master!' For I Myself have spoken this word, declares the LORD." [6] In Jerusalem, then, Jeremiah the prophet relayed all these words to Zedekiah king of Judah

[7] as the army of the king of Babylon was fighting against Jerusalem and the remaining cities of Judah—against Lachish and Azekah. For these were the only fortified cities remaining in Judah. [8] After King Zedekiah had made a covenant with all the people in Jerusalem to proclaim liberty, the word came to Jeremiah from the LORD [9] that each man should free his Hebrew slaves, both male and female, and no one should hold his fellow Jew in bondage.

[10] So all the officials and all the people who entered into this covenant agreed that they would free their menservants and maidservants and no longer hold them in bondage. They obeyed and released them, [11] but later they changed their minds and took back the menservants and maidservants they had freed, and they forced them to become slaves again. [12] Then the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying, [13] "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: I made a covenant with your forefathers when I brought them out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of slavery, saying:" [14] Every seventh year, each of you must free his Hebrew brother who has sold himself to you. He may serve you six years, but then you must let him go free. But your fathers did not listen or incline their ear. [15] Recently you repented and did what pleased Me; each of you proclaimed freedom for his neighbor. You made a covenant before Me in the house that bears My Name. [16] But now you have changed your minds and profaned My name. Each of you has taken back the menservants and maidservants whom you had set at liberty to go wherever they wanted, and you have again forced them to be your slaves. [17] Therefore this is what the LORD says: You have not obeyed Me; you have not proclaimed freedom, each man for his brother and for his neighbor. So now I proclaim freedom for you, declares the LORD—freedom to fall by sword, by plague, and by famine! I will make you a horror to all the kingdoms of the earth. [18] And those who have transgressed My covenant and have not fulfilled the terms of the covenant they made before Me, I will treat like the calf they cut in two in order to pass between its pieces. [19] The officials of Judah and Jerusalem, the court officials, the priests, and all the people of the land who passed between the pieces of the calf, [20] I will deliver into the hands of their enemies who seek their lives. Their corpses will become food for the birds of the air and the beasts of the earth. [21] And I will deliver Zedekiah king of Judah and his officials into the hands of their enemies who seek their lives, to the army of the king of Babylon that had withdrawn from you. [22] "Behold, I am going to give the command, declares the LORD, and I will bring them back to this city. They will fight against it, capture it, and burn it down. And I will make the cities of Judah a desolation, without inhabitant."

35 This is the word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD in the days of Jehoiakim son of Josiah king of Judah: [2] "Go to the house of the Rechabites, speak to them, and bring them to one of the chambers of the house of the LORD to offer them a drink of wine." [3] So I took Jaazaniah son of Jeremiah, the son of Habazziniah, and his brothers and all his sons—the entire house of the Rechabites — [4] and I brought them into the house of the LORD, to a chamber occupied by the sons of Hanan son of Igdaliah, a man of God. This room was near the chamber of the officials, which was above the chamber of Maaseiah son of Shallum the doorkeeper. [5] Then I set pitchers full of wine and some cups before the men of the house of the Rechabites, and I said to them, "Drink some wine." [6] "We do not drink wine," they replied, "for our forefather Jonadab son of Rechab commanded us, 'Neither you nor your descendants are ever to drink wine.'" [7] Nor are you ever to build a house or sow seed or plant a vineyard. Those things are not for you. Instead, you must live in tents all your lives, so that you may live a long time in the land where you wander.' [8] And we have obeyed the voice of our forefather Jonadab son of Rechab in all he commanded us. So we have not drunk wine all our lives—neither we nor our wives nor our sons and daughters. [9] Nor have we built houses in which to live, and we have not owned any vineyards or fields or crops.

[10] But we have lived in tents and have obeyed and done exactly as our forefather Jonadab commanded us. [11] "So when Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon marched into the land, we said: 'Come, let us go into Jerusalem to escape the armies of the Chaldeans and the Arameans.' So we have remained in Jerusalem." [12] Then the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah: [13] "This is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: Go and tell the men of Judah and the residents of Jerusalem: 'Will you not accept discipline and obey My words?' declares the LORD." [14] The words of Jonadab son of Rechab have been carried out. He commanded his sons not to drink wine, and they have not drunk it to this very day because they have obeyed the command of their forefather. But I have spoken to you again and again, and you have not obeyed Me! [15] Again and again I have sent you all My servants the prophets, proclaiming: 'Turn now, each of you, from your wicked ways, and correct your actions. Do not go after other gods to serve them. Live in the land that I have given to you and your fathers.' But you have not inclined your ear or listened to Me. [16] Yes, the sons of Jonadab son of Rechab carried out the command their forefather gave them, but these people have not listened to Me. [17] "Therefore this is what the LORD God of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'Behold, I will bring to Judah and to all the residents of Jerusalem all the disaster I have pronounced against them, because I have spoken to them but they have not obeyed, and I have called to them but they have not answered.'" [18] Then Jeremiah said to the house of the Rechabites: "This is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'Because you have obeyed the command of your forefather Jonadab and have kept all his commandments and have done all that he charged you to do,'" [19] "this is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: Jonadab son of Rechab will never fail to have a man to stand before Me.'"

36 In the fourth year of Jehoiakim son of Josiah king of Judah, this word came
to Jeremiah from the LORD: [2] "Take a scroll and write on it all the words I have
spoken to you concerning Israel, Judah, and all the nations, from the day I first
spoke to you during the reign of Josiah until today." [3] "Perhaps when the people of
Judah hear about all the calamity I plan to bring upon them, each of them will turn
from his wicked way. Then I will forgive their iniquity and their sin." [4] So Jeremiah
called Baruch son of Neriah, and at the dictation of Jeremiah, Baruch wrote on
a scroll all the words that the LORD had spoken to Jeremiah. [5] Then Jeremiah
commanded Baruch, "I am restricted; I cannot enter the house of the LORD;" [6] so
you are to go to the house of the LORD on a day of fasting, and in the hearing
of the people you are to read the words of the LORD from the scroll you have
written at my dictation. Read them in the hearing of all the people of Judah who
are coming from their cities. [7] "Perhaps they will bring their petition before the
LORD, and each one will turn from his wicked way; for great are the anger and fury
that the LORD has pronounced against this people." [8] So Baruch son of Neriah
did everything that Jeremiah the prophet had commanded him. In the house of the
LORD he read the words of the LORD from the scroll. [9] Now in the ninth month
of the fifth year of Jehoiakim son of Josiah king of Judah, a fast before the LORD
was proclaimed to all the people of Jerusalem and all who had come there from the
cities of Judah.

[10] From the chamber of Gemariah son of Shaphan the scribe, which was in the
upper courtyard at the opening of the New Gate of the house of the LORD, Baruch
read from the scroll the words of Jeremiah in the hearing of all the people. [11] When
Micaiah son of Gemariah, the son of Shaphan, heard all the words of the LORD
from the scroll, [12] he went down to the scribe's chamber in the king's palace, where
all the officials were sitting: Elishama the scribe, Delaiah son of Shemaiah, Elnathan
son of Achbor, Gemariah son of Shaphan, Zedekiah son of Hananiah, and all the
other officials. [13] And Micaiah reported to them all the words he had heard Baruch
read from the scroll in the hearing of the people.

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